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Carrier-Free Micro Light Source Image Sensing Device

Abstract

A carrier-free micro light source image sensing device includes an image sensor, a light source module, and a packaging layer. The image sensor is placed on a first positioning area of a temporary carrier; the light source module is adjacent to one side of the image sensor. The light source module includes a supporter and a light-emitting element. The light source module is placed on a second positioning area of a temporary carrier. The altitude of a light-emitting face of the light source element is lower than or equal to that of a sensing face of the image sensor. The packaging layer covers the image sensor and the light source module but reveals the sensing face and the light-emitting face. The temporary carrier is removed after the packaging layer is cured. The present invention can minimize the size of the light source image sensing device, simplify the production process, improve the overall product quality, increase the signal-to-noise ratio, and enhance image quality.

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Background/Summary

1. FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0001] The present invention relates to an endoscopic light source image sensing device, particularly to a carrier-free micro light source image sensing device.

2. DESCRIPTION OF THE PRIOR ART

[0002] In general, the fabrication of an endoscopic light source image sensing module needs a piece of carrier for carrying an optical sensing instrument and a light source module (such as LED). If the carrier is a flexible printed circuit (FPC), the fabrication needs an additional CAP process to cover the optical sensing device or package the optical sensing device for protecting the surface or functioning as a light shield layer. If the position of LED needs raising, FPC must be bent and then fixed. Thus, the volume of the overall optical image module will become too larger to be assembled in fabrication. Besides, a resin must be filled into the gap between the CAP structure and the optical sensor to fix them. Therefore, a sufficient space must be preserved to allow a resin-dispensing needle to enter the gap, which will further increase the volume of the overall module and impair the miniaturization of endoscopes.

[0003] At present, all the existing light source image sensing modules use carriers. Thus, the overall height or length of the module must involve the thickness of the carrier. The abovementioned technology can fabricate endoscopes easily, but it is not a technology to realize miniaturization. Accordingly, the present invention proposes a carrier-free micro light source image sensing device to overcome the conventional problems.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0004] One objective of the present invention is to provide a carrier-free micro light source image sensing device, which is applicable to endoscopes, wherein the size of the light source image sensing device is minimized, whereby to simplify the fabrication process and promote the overall mass-production quality, and whereby to avoid the signal loss induced by using a carrier or an adaptor board, raise the signal-to-noise ratio, and enhance the image quality.

[0005] In order to achieve the abovementioned objective, the present invention provides a carrier-free micro light source image sensing device, which comprises an image sensor, a light source module, and a packaging layer. The image sensor has a sensing face and a connection face opposite to the sensing face. The connection face contacts the surface of a temporary carrier and is corresponding to a first positioning area of the temporary carrier. The light source module is adjacent to one side of the image sensor and includes a supporter and a light-emitting element. The supporter of the light source module contacts the surface of the temporary carrier and is corresponding to a second positioning area. The second positioning area is adjacent to the first positioning area. The light-emitting element is disposed on the supporter and has a light-emitting face. The altitude of the light-emitting face is lower than or equal to the altitude of the sensing face of the image sensor. The packaging layer covers the image sensor and the light-emitting element except the sensing face and the light-emitting face. The packaging layer fixes the image sensor and the light source module to form a packaged workpiece. Then, the temporary carrier is removed from the packaged workpiece to form a carrier-free micro light source image sensing device.

[0006] In one embodiment, the light-emitting module further comprises an intermediate supporter, which is disposed between the supporter and the light-emitting element.

[0007] In one embodiment, the light-emitting module further comprises a light shield layer, which encapsulates the perimeter of the light-emitting module but reveals the light-emitting face.

[0008] In one embodiment, the light-emitting element is a light-emitting diode (LED) chip.

[0009] In one embodiment, the light source module further comprises a fluorescent powder layer, which covers the light-emitting element.

[0010] In one embodiment, the supporter includes a first connection member and a second connection member. The first connection member is disposed on the top surface of the supporter, and the second connection member is disposed on the bottom surface of the supporter. The first connection member is connected with the bottom of the light-emitting element or the bottom of the intermediate supporter.

[0011] In one embodiment, the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device further comprises a transmission wire. The supporter has a second connection member on the bottom surface thereof. The transmission wire is connected with the connection face of the image sensor and the second connection member of the supporter.

[0012] In one embodiment, the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device further comprises a transparent covering layer. The transparent covering layer is disposed on the surface of the packaging layer and covers the light source module. The transparent covering layer does not cover the sensing face of the image sensor.

[0013] In one embodiment, the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device further comprises an electronic element. The bottom of the electronic element contacts the temporary carrier and is corresponding to a third positioning area. The electronic element is disposed on one side of the light source module, which is away from the image sensor. The packaging layer covers the electronic element.

[0014] Because the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device of the present invention needn't use a carrier, the overall mass-production efficiency is raised, and the overall module size is highly miniaturized. In practical application, the wire can be directly soldered to the image sensor and the light source module. Thus, the present invention can avoid the signal loss resulting from using a carrier or another adapter board. Further, the signal-to-noise ratio is increased, and the image quality is enhanced. Besides, the light source module may be equipped with LEDs emitting lights of different wavelengths or colors, such as white light LEDs and infrared LEDs, which may be switched on respectively or simultaneously to provide illumination according to requirement. Therefore, the present invention can increase the design flexibility and expand the application range.

[0015] The objective, technologies, features and advantages of the present invention will become apparent from the following description in conjunction with the accompanying drawings wherein certain embodiments of the present invention are set forth by way of illustration and example.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0016] The foregoing conceptions and their accompanying advantages of this invention will become more readily appreciated after being better understood by referring to the following detailed description, in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, wherein

[0017] FIG. 1A is a diagram schematically showing a carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to a first embodiment of the present invention, wherein the temporary carrier is separated from the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device;

[0018] FIG. 1B is a diagram schematically showing the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to the first embodiment of the present invention;

[0019] FIGS. 2A-2C are diagrams schematically showing the temporary carrier and the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to the first embodiment of the present invention;

[0020] FIGS. 3-6 are diagrams schematically showing several embodiments of the light source

module of the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to the first embodiment of the present invention;

[0021] FIG. 7 is a diagram schematically showing a carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to a second embodiment of the present invention;

[0022] FIG. 8 is a diagram schematically showing a local area of the temporary carrier of a carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to a third embodiment of the present invention; and

[0023] FIG. 9 is a diagram schematically showing the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to the third embodiment of the present invention.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

[0024] Various embodiments of the present invention will be described in detail below and illustrated in conjunction with the accompanying drawings. In addition to these detailed descriptions, the present invention can be widely implemented in other embodiments, and apparent alternations, modifications and equivalent changes of any mentioned embodiments are all included within the scope of the present invention and based on the scope of the Claims. In the descriptions of the specification, in order to make readers have a more complete understanding about the present invention, many specific details are provided; however, the present invention may be implemented without parts of or all the specific details. In addition, the well-known steps or elements are not described in detail, in order to avoid unnecessary limitations to the present invention. Same or similar elements in Figures will be indicated by same or similar reference numbers. It is noted that the Figures are schematic and may not represent the actual size or number of the elements. For clearness of the Figures, some details may not be fully depicted.

[0025] Refer to FIG. 1A and FIG. 1B. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device **1** of the present invention comprises an image sensor **10**, light source modules **20**, and a packaging layer **30**. The image sensor **10** has a sensing face **10A** and a connection face **10B**, which are opposite to each other. The symbol **10B** in FIG. 2A indicates the connection face. The connection face **10B** contacts a temporary carrier TC and is corresponding to a first positioning area A1 of the temporary carrier TC. The light source module **20** is adjacent to one side of the image sensor **10**. The packaging layer **30** covers the image sensor **10** and the light source module **20** except the sensing face **10A** of the image sensor **10** and a light-emitting face **240** of the light-emitting element **24**. Thus, the packaging layer **30** fixes the image sensor **10** and the light-emitting module **20** but reveals the sensing face **10A** of the image sensor **10** and the light-emitting face **240** of the light source module **20**, whereby to form a packaged workpiece **100**. The temporary carrier TC is removed to form the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device **1**, as shown in FIG. 1B. In the embodiment, there are two light-emitting modules **20**. However, the present invention only demands that there should be at least one light-emitting module **20**. If there are more than one light-emitting module **20**, the light-emitting modules **20** may be disposed in the perimeter of the image sensor **10** or in asymmetric positions. The present invention is not limited by the layout in FIG. 1. Besides, the light-emitting module **20** may be equipped with several LEDs respectively emitting lights of different wavelengths or colors, such as white light LEDs and infrared LEDs, which may be switched on respectively or simultaneously to provide illumination according to requirement.

[0026] Refer to FIGS. 2A-2C. Below are introduced the technical characteristics of the temporary carrier TC and the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device **1**. As shown in FIG. 2A, there is a plurality of groups of positioning symbols A, which are arranged in array and to be recognized by the fabrication apparatus in the succeeding process. Each group of positioning symbols A includes at least one first positioning area A1 and at least one second positioning area A2. The first positioning area A1 neighbors the second positioning area A2. The first positioning area A1 includes at least one positioning point for the positioning of the image sensor **10**. The second positioning area A2 includes at least one positioning point for the positioning of the light-emitting module **20**. The first positioning area A1 and the second positioning area A2 may be

fabricated in a printing method or another method. The numbers, distances, and positions of the first positioning area A1 and the second positioning area A2 are designed in advance, which favors the miniaturization of the overall device and enables the image sensors **10** and the light-emitting modules **20** to be precisely positioned in fabrication, whereby waste material is reduced in fabrication. The light-emitting module **20** includes a supporter **22** and a light-emitting element **24**. The supporter **22** of the light-emitting module **20** contacts the temporary carrier TC and is corresponding to the second positioning area A2 of the temporary carrier TC. The light-emitting element **24** is disposed on supporter **22** and has a light-emitting face **240**. The altitude of the light-emitting face **240** of the light-emitting element **24** is preferably smaller than or equal to the altitude of the sensing face **10A** of the image sensor **10**. The altitude of the light-emitting face **240** is correlated with the height of the supporter **22**. Therefore, the height of the supporter **22** may be adjusted to meet the illumination requirement. As shown in FIG. 2B, after the image sensor **10** and the light-emitting module **20** have been secured to the temporary carrier TC, a light shield material is filled into the areas between and around the image sensor **10** and the light-emitting module **20**. The packaging layer **30** is formed after the light shield material is cured. It should be noted: the packaging layer **30** is not allowed to cover the sensing face **10A** of the image sensor **10** and the light-emitting face **240** of the light-emitting element **24**. In other words, the packaging layer **30** must reveal the sensing face **10A** and the light-emitting face **240** to prevent the light of the light-emitting element **24** from entering the image sensor **10** lest stray light affect image quality. The cured light shield material fixes and protects the image sensor **10** and the light-emitting module **20**. As shown in FIG. 2C, after the packaging layer **30** is cured, the packaging layer **30** fixes the image sensor **10** and the light-emitting module **20** to form a packaged workpiece **100**. The temporary carrier TC is cut off along the boundary of the packaged workpiece **100** or along cutting lines to remove the temporary carrier TC. Thus is obtained the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device **1**.

[0027] FIGS. 3-6 will introduce several embodiments of the light source module. In FIG. 3, Section (A) shows the overall structure of the light source module **20A**; Section (B) shows the structure of the supporter **22**. The light source module **20A** includes the supporter **22** and the light-emitting element **24**. The supporter **22** has a first connection member **22A** and a second connection member **22B**. The first connection member **22A** is disposed on the top surface of the supporter **22**; the second connection member **22B** is disposed on the bottom surface of the supporter **22**. The first connection member **22A** is joined with the bottom of the light-emitting element **24**. The light-emitting element **24** is a light-emitting diode (LED) chip. Different LED chips respectively having different wavelengths and different color temperatures may be used to meet different requirements. The surface and interior of the supporter **22** has circuits and solder pads, which enable the LED chip to be disposed on the surface of the supporter **22** and connected with the internal circuits of the supporter **22**.

[0028] Refer to FIG. 4. The light source module **20B** includes a supporter **22**, a light-emitting element **24**, and a fluorescent powder layer **27**. The embodiment is different from the abovementioned embodiment in the fluorescent powder layer **27**. The characteristics of the supporter **22** have been described in detail hereinbefore and will not repeat herein. The fluorescent powder layer **27** covers the light-emitting element **24** and emits a light source suitable to terminal products, such as endoscopes. The light-emitting element **24** may be a light-emitting diode (LED). The fluorescent powder layer **27** is coated on the surfaces of the light-emitting diode. For example, a blue light LED excites the yellow light fluorescent powder (such as YAG); the complementary yellow light and blue light are mixed to form high-brightness white light. Thus, is obtained a white light LED. Therefore, the fluorescent powder layer **27** can vary the color of the light emitted by LED and enhance the light efficiency.

[0029] Refer to FIG. 5. The light source module **20C** includes a supporter **22**, a light-emitting element **24**, and an intermediate supporter **26**. The embodiment is different from the

abovementioned embodiment in the intermediate supporter **26**. The characteristics of the supporter **22** and the light-emitting element **24** have been described in detail hereinbefore and will not repeat herein. The intermediate supporter **26** is disposed between the supporter **22** and the light-emitting element **24**, able to increase the stability of the fabrication process, promote the performance of the products, and provide more flexibility of design. The top surface and bottom surface of the intermediate supporter **26** are respectively connected with the light-emitting element **24** and the supporter **22**, providing an effective heat-conduction path and favoring heat dissipation of the light-emitting element **24**, whereby to prevent the interior circuits of the supporter **22** from being damaged by poor heat dissipation of the light-emitting element **24** and increase the reliability and service life of the products. The intermediate supporter **26** may provide a stabilization layer for the succeeding electric processing or increase the flexibility of design. For example, the intermediate supporter **26** may be used in circuit fabrication, test, miniaturizing/thinning processes, adding more functional layers, or using different materials to promote the overall performance of the modules.

[0030] Refer to FIG. 6. The light source module **20D** includes a supporter **22**, a light-emitting element **24**, and a light shield layer **28**. The embodiment is different from the abovementioned embodiment in the light shield layer **28**. The characteristics of the supporter **22** and the light-emitting element **24** have been described in detail hereinbefore and will not repeat herein. The light shield layer **28** covers the perimeter of the light-emitting element **24** but reveals the light-emitting face **240**. The light shield layer **28** may be made of a light shield material having a diffusing or scattering function. The light shield layer **28** can increase the stability and the light-emitting efficiency and prevent from the interference of external light sources.

[0031] Refer to FIG. 7. The embodiment is different from the first embodiment in transmission wires **50** and a transparent covering layer **60**. The identical elements will not repeat herein. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device **1'** of the present invention further comprises transmission wires **50** and a transparent covering layer **60**. The bottom surface of the supporter **22** has a second connection member (indicated by the symbol **22B** in FIG. 3 (B)). The transmission wires **50** may be connected with the connection face (indicated by the symbol **10B** in FIG. 2A) of the image sensor **10** and the second connection member of the supporter **22**. The transparent covering layer **60** is disposed on the surface of the packaging layer **30** and covers the light-emitting module **20**, but the transparent covering layer **60** does not cover the sensing face **10A** of the image sensor **10**. In other words, the transparent covering layer **60** reveals the sensing face **10A**. The transparent covering layer **60** may be but is not limited to be made of a transparent resin material. The transparent covering layer **60** covers the light source module **20** and protects the light-emitting element **24**, but the transparent covering layer **60** is not allowed to cover the sensing face **10A** of the image sensor **10**.

[0032] The transmission wires **50** may directly connect the wire, the image sensor **10** and the light source module **20** in a soldering method without using a carrier or any adapter material, whereby to eliminate the source of noise completely, increase the signal-to-noise ratio and enhance the image quality. Besides, a protective resin material **80** may be disposed on the exterior of the transmission wires **50**, whereby to prevent the transmission wires from dropping off and avoid interruption of signals and power supply.

[0033] Refer to FIG. 8 and FIG. 9. The embodiment is different from the second embodiment shown in FIG. 7 in the temporary carrier **TC'** and an electronic element **70**. The identical elements will not repeat herein. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device **1''** of the present invention further comprises an electronic element **70**. Each group of the positioning symbols **A'** on the temporary carrier **TC** further includes a third position area **A3** in addition to the first positioning area **A1** and the second positioning area **A2**. The third positioning area **A3** may be disposed on one side of the second positioning area **A2**, which is away from the first positioning area **A1**. The bottom of the electronic element **70** contacts the surface of the temporary carrier **TC'** and is corresponding to the third positioning area **A3**. The electronic element **70** is disposed on one side of

the light source module **20**, which is away from the image sensor **10**. The packaging layer **30** covers the electronic element **70**. The electronic element **70** may be but is not limited to be a functional element, a thermistor, or a pressure sensor. For example, while the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device **1"** of the present invention is applied to an endoscope, the thermistor may detect temperature variation and provide temperature data to enhance the accuracy of image analysis; the pressure sensor may detect the pressure of liquid or gas and provide pressure data, such as the contact pressure on the inspected object, whereby the inspection not only performs observation but also provides abundant data for image analysis. Therefore, the present invention can increase the performance and application field of the module and endoscope.

[0034] While the invention is susceptible to various modifications and alternative forms, a specific example thereof has been shown in the drawings and is herein described in detail. It should be understood, however, that the invention is not to be limited to the particular form disclosed, but to the contrary, the invention is to cover all modifications, equivalents, and alternatives falling within the appended claims.

Claims

1. A carrier-free micro light source image sensing device, comprising an image sensor, having a sensing face and a connection face opposite to the sensing face, wherein the connection face contacts a surface of a temporary carrier and is corresponding to a first positioning area of the temporary carrier; a light source module, adjacent to one side of the image sensor and including a supporter, contacting the surface of the temporary carrier and corresponding to a second positioning area of the temporary carrier, wherein the second positioning area is adjacent to the first positioning area; and a light-emitting element, disposed on the supporter and having a light-emitting face, wherein an altitude of the light-emitting face is lower than or equal to an altitude of the sensing face of the image sensor; and a packaging layer, covering the image sensor and the light-emitting element but revealing the sensing face and the light-emitting face, wherein the packaging layer fixes the image sensor and the light source module to form a packaged workpiece, wherein the temporary carrier is removed from the packaged workpiece to form the carrier-free micro light source image sensing device.
2. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 1, wherein the light-emitting module further comprises an intermediate supporter, which is disposed between the supporter and the light-emitting element.
3. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 1, wherein the light-emitting module further comprises a light shield layer, which encapsulates a perimeter of the light-emitting element but reveals the light-emitting face.
4. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 1, wherein the light-emitting element is a light-emitting diode (LED) chip.
5. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 1, wherein the light source module further comprises a fluorescent powder layer, which covers the light-emitting element.
6. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 1, wherein the supporter includes a first connection member and a second connection member; the first connection member is disposed on a top surface of the supporter, and the second connection member is disposed on a bottom of the supporter; the first connection member is connected with a bottom of the light-emitting element.
7. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 2, wherein the supporter includes a first connection member and a second connection member; the first connection member is disposed on the top surface of the supporter, and the second connection member is disposed on the bottom of the supporter; the first connection member is connected with a bottom of

the light-emitting element or a bottom of the intermediate supporter.

8. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 1, further comprising a transmission wire, wherein the supporter has a second connection member on a bottom surface thereof; the transmission wire is connected with the connection face of the image sensor and the second connection member of the supporter.

9. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 1, further comprising a transparent covering layer, which is disposed on a surface of the packaging layer and covers the light source module; the transparent covering layer does not cover the sensing face of the image sensor.

10. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 1, further comprising an electronic element, wherein a bottom of the electronic element contacts the temporary carrier and is corresponding to a third positioning area of the temporary carrier; the electronic element is disposed on one side of the light source module, which is away from the image sensor; the packaging layer covers the electronic element.

11. The carrier-free micro light source image sensing device according to claim 10, wherein the third positioning area is formed on a surface of the temporary carrier; the third positioning area is adjacent to the second positioning area and away from the first positioning area.
